Core returns the status code and an empty response body. The browser is left to display some kind of notification to the user (although it is not obliged to). You can take control of what is displayed to the user yourself by adding StatusCodePages middleware to the request pipeline, which you will test out in the next section.

12.2 StatusCodePages

StatusCodePages middleware is designed to enable you to provide a response body in the event of a client error occurring. The default implementation generates a plain text response, but you can produce a custom HTML-based error page and configure the middleware to return the contents of that instead. This enables you to fully control the appearance of the error message, maintain your site branding if so desired, and give the user helpful information on what happened and what they can do next.

Use the `UseStatusCodePages` extension method (set in bold) to enable StatusCodePages middleware. Ideally this method call should be registered early in the pipeline, before any request handling components:

```
app.UseHttpsRedirection();
app.UseStatusCodePages();
app.UseStaticFiles();
```

The primary processing logic within StatusCodePages middleware comes after the `await _next(context)` call, which, if you remember from chapter 2, happens on the *return leg* of the pipeline, once the response status code has been set by other middleware—usually the Razor Pages middleware (figure 12.3).